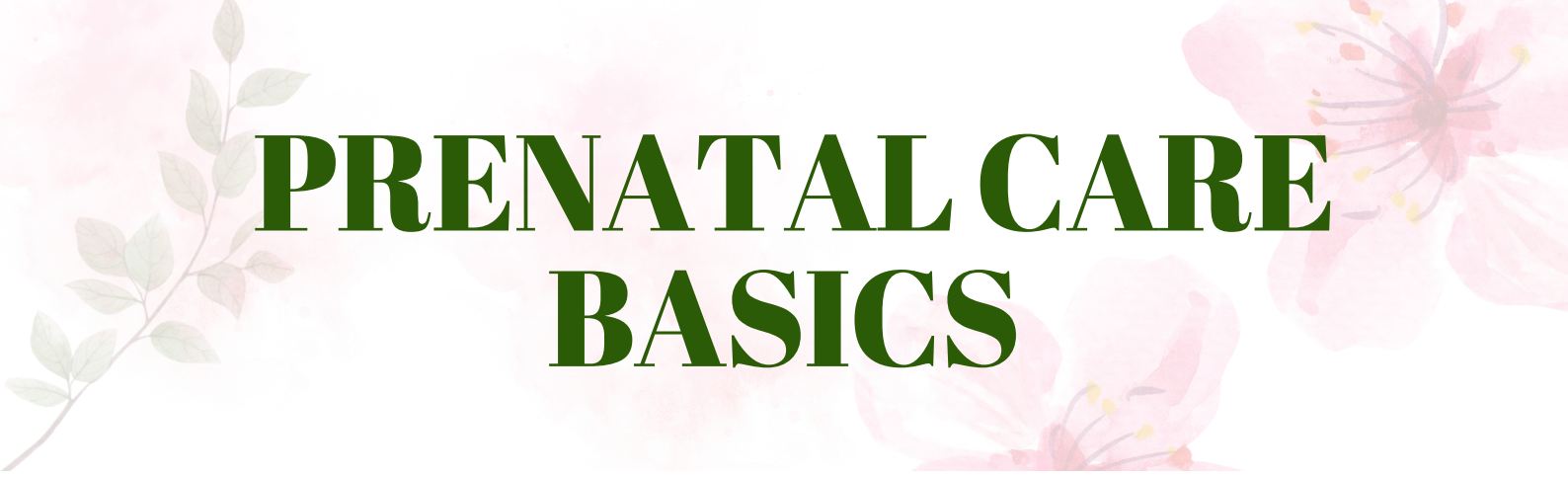




PRENATAL CARE BASICS

What Is Prenatal Care?

Prenatal care is the healthcare provided during pregnancy to monitor the health of both the pregnant person and the developing baby. Regular visits allow healthcare providers to detect and manage potential complications early.

Recommended Prenatal Visit Schedule

- Weeks 4–28: One visit per month
- Weeks 28–36: One visit every two weeks
- Weeks 36–40: One visit per week
- After week 40: More frequent monitoring if pregnancy continues

What Happens at Prenatal Visits?

- Blood pressure and weight monitoring
- Urine tests for protein, sugar, and signs of infection
- Fetal heartbeat monitoring
- Measurement of uterine growth
- Blood tests (anemia, blood type, infections, genetic screening)
- Ultrasounds to monitor fetal development
- Discussion of symptoms, nutrition, exercise, and birth planning

Benefits of Early and Consistent Prenatal Care

- Reduces the risk of preterm birth and low birth weight
- Allows early detection of gestational diabetes and preeclampsia
- Supports healthy nutrition and weight management
- Provides education and emotional support
- Improves outcomes for both parent and baby

Key Takeaway

Prenatal care should begin as early as possible, ideally within the first 8 weeks of pregnancy. Consistent follow-up throughout pregnancy is one of the most important steps for a healthy outcome.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Prenatal care. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2022). Prenatal care. Office on Women's Health. (2021). Prenatal care and tests..